

China Software: Apr revenue growth slowed to 8.9% YoY; New products continue to focus on AI agents and industry AI platforms

China Software

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China software industry growth in Apr was +8.9% YoY (vs. Mar 2026/ Apr 2025 at +11.6%/ 11.5% YoY), slower than previous months, leading to aggregate **4M26 revenues growth of +10.9% YoY** (vs. 4M25 at 10.8% YoY). Looking into 2Q ahead, we expect to see sequential QoQ growth with better seasonality, while we see the software spending remains under pressures with allocation to AI foundational model and customized AI model projects. As we highlighted in the [Private Tech Tour report](#), we see accelerated monetization and expanding use cases of AI agents, for example, AI agents to retain experienced employees' know-how in-house, or diversify the production sites with higher efficiency. For ToC, we see users leveraging multi-modal AI models to generate content, and adopt personal AI assistants on daily basis (e.g. search file, chat etc.).

We monitor AI product momentum, SMB PMI data, company hiring, profitability, and product iteration to track the path of software spending recovery in China. By segment, semi design, IT services, and cloud computing and big data outperformed in Apr, with IT services contributing the major revenues in the China software industry. The SMB PMI was down in May and showed volatility recently. On new products, we see Meitu will host annual product launch event on Jun 17th, focusing on AI agents and generative AI products. Glodon recently released AI products incl. PMLead, PMSmart, with focus on platform strategy to better integrate data.

Buy: AI: Sensetime, Meitu; Finance: Hundsun; IoT software: TUYA. Read more: [China Software product tracker](#); [Sensetime UG to Buy](#); [Meitu initiation](#).

Apr software industry growth slowed; May SMB PMI MoM declined

China software industry growth slowed to 8.9% YoY in Apr 2026 (vs. 11.6% in Mar 2026), and the SMB PMI was down to 48.5 in May (vs. 49.3/ 50.1 in Mar/ Apr). We expect to see improving QoQ in 2Q26E on better seasonality, while overall the clients' software spending remained weak, and some of projects were on AI foundational models and customized AI models. We see rising adoption of AI features, and expect to see new progress in foundational AI models for text/ image/

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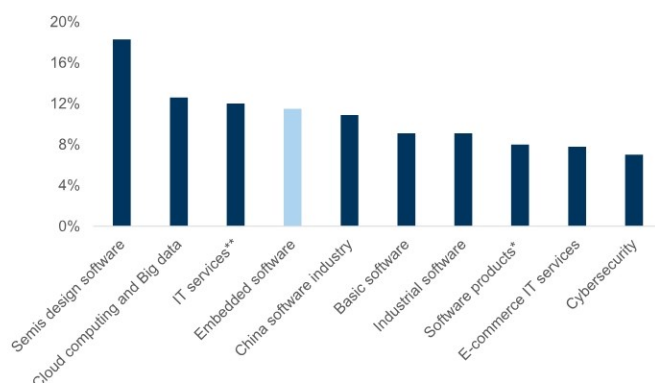
video content generation to drive the application ecosystem to drive clients' IT spending.

China software sector key indicators:

- **China SMB PMI:** The PMI data reflects economic momentum and is correlated with the software market and customer budgets. In May 2026, SMB PMI decreased to 48.5 from 50.1 in April ([Exhibit 3](#)).
- **Margin improved in Apr 2026:** We saw China software industry net margin at 12% in Apr vs. net margin at 9.0% in Mar, per MIIT, showing improving operational efficiency.

Exhibit 1: China software industry growth was at 11% YoY in 4M26

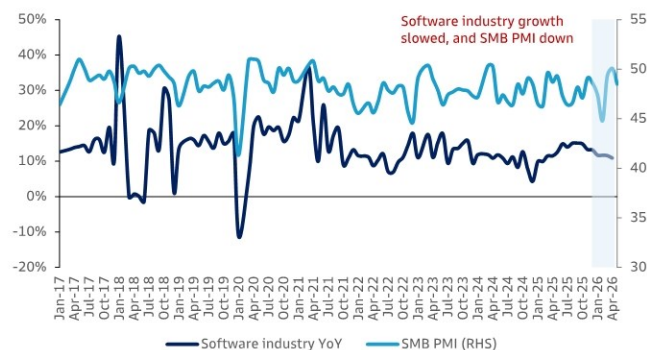
4M26 China Software industry revenue growth by segment



*software products include industrial software; **IT services include E-commerce IT services, semis design software, cloud computing and big data.

Source: MIIT

Exhibit 2: Software industry growth slowed in Apr 2026; SMB PMI was weak in May 2026



Source: MIIT, NBS

Software Monthly: Apr revenues down to 8.9% YoY with MoM decline

Apr 2026 China software quick read:

- 1. Revenue +8.9% YoY, leading to 4M26 at 10.9% YoY, slower than 1Q26 growth of 11.6% YoY:** In April, the aggregate revenue of software companies registered in China was up +8.9% YoY to Rmb1.2trn (US\$163bn), resulting in 4M26 revenue growth of +10.9% YoY, while going down from 1Q26 of 11.6% YoY, per MIIT.
- 2. Net margin was 12.0%, leading to 4M26 at 11.4%, higher vs. 1Q26 of 11.2%:** In April, the aggregate net income of software companies registered in China was Rmb141bn (US\$19.6bn), or net margin of 12.0% (vs. 9.0% in Mar 2026), resulting in 4M26 net margin of 11.4%, higher than 1Q26 net margin of 11.2%, per MIIT.
- 3. Overseas exposure up to 3.1%:** In April, the aggregate revenue for non-China markets from software companies registered in China was US\$5.1bn, and overseas exposure was up to 3.1% (vs. 2.8% in Mar 2026).
- 4. IT services remain a key contributor:** In 4M26, the aggregate revenue of software companies registered in China (Rmb4.7trn) was mainly generated from IT services

(67% of the total), followed by software products at 22%, embedded system software at 9%, and security software and services at 2%, per MIIT.

Exhibit 3: China software market snapshot

	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sep-25	Oct-25	Nov-25	Dec-25	Jan-Feb 26	Mar-26	Apr-26
China software market													
Total revenues (Rmb m)*	1,199,469	1,080,566	1,370,672	1,479,600	1,266,200	1,316,100	1,471,800	1,397,700	1,467,300	1,505,500	2,153,500	1,338,500	1,176,600
Software products	290,996	239,396	278,911	296,300	257,000	310,200	274,100	265,000	300,500	285,200	472,700	318,800	254,900
IT services	793,787	723,960	1,012,100	1,026,600	888,400	867,000	1,051,700	962,000	1,005,100	1,026,200	1,447,400	895,700	790,100
Security software	22,601	19,726	-2,421	26,500	12,900	20,000	24,600	18,300	19,100	23,400	41,200	24,800	20,800
Embedded system software	92,085	97,484	82,083	130,200	107,900	118,900	121,400	152,400	142,600	170,700	192,200	99,200	110,800
MoM		-10%	27%	8%	-14%	4%	12%	-5%	5%	3%			-12%
Software products		-18%	17%	6%	-13%	21%	-12%	-3%	13%	-5%			-20%
IT services		-9%	40%	1%	-13%	-2%	21%	-9%	4%	2%			-12%
Security software		-13%	-112%	-1194%	-51%	55%	23%	-26%	4%	23%			-16%
Embedded system software		6%	-16%	59%	-17%	10%	2%	26%	-6%	20%			12%
YoY	12%	11%	13%	15%	14%	15%	15%	15%	15%	12%	12%	12%	9%
Software products	11%	10%	11%	14%	11%	16%	8%	14%	13%	1%	8%	10%	6%
IT services	12%	13%	13%	16%	16%	16%	18%	15%	16%	16%	13%	13%	9%
Security software	12%	8%	8%	8%	-8%	11%	7%	3%	11%	5%	6%	10%	5%
Embedded system software	8%	5%	9%	7%	9%	10%	9%	16%	6%	9%	12%	8%	14%
Mix	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%
Software products	24%	22%	20%	20%	20%	24%	19%	19%	20%	19%	22%	24%	22%
IT services	66%	67%	74%	69%	70%	66%	71%	69%	68%	68%	67%	67%	67%
Security software	2%	2%	0%	2%	1%	2%	2%	1%	1%	2%	2%	2%	2%
Embedded system software	8%	9%	6%	9%	9%	9%	8%	11%	10%	11%	9%	7%	9%
Total net income (Rmb m)*	134,566	133,438	153,118	186,000	230,900	229,600	116,600	136,900	123,300	189,400	269,300	120,100	141,000
MoM		-1%	15%	21%	24%	-1%	-49%	17%	-10%	54%			
YoY	13%	22%	8%	9%	14%	16%	-24%	-2%	-6%	14%	7%	-11%	6%
Net margin	11.2%	12.3%	11.2%	12.6%	18.2%	17.4%	7.9%	9.8%	8.4%	12.6%	12.5%	9.0%	12.0%
Total revenues (Rmb m)	1,199,469	1,080,566	1,370,672	1,479,600	1,266,200	1,316,100	1,471,800	1,397,700	1,467,300	1,505,500	2,153,500	1,338,500	1,176,600
From China market	1,166,120	1,048,653	1,338,735	1,439,352	1,225,304	1,269,588	1,432,200	1,360,620	1,425,540	1,463,452	2,078,764	1,300,916	1,140,240
From non-China markets	33,349	31,912	31,937	40,248	40,896	46,512	39,600	37,080	41,760	42,048	74,736	37,584	36,360
Export ratio	3%	3%	2%	3%	3%	4%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%

*Aggregate revenue/net income for software companies registered in China. IT services growth was mainly driven by cloud computing and big data segment.

Source: MIIT

Exhibit 4: China software market continued to grow in Apr 2026

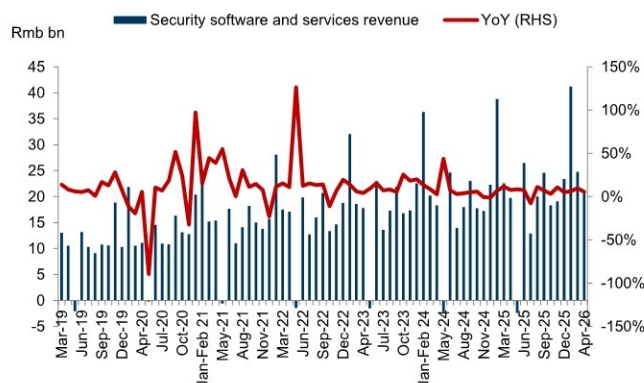
Software companies registered in China: aggregate revenues and YoY



Source: MIIT

Exhibit 5: China security software revenues growth was at 5% YoY in Apr (vs. 10% YoY in Mar 2026)

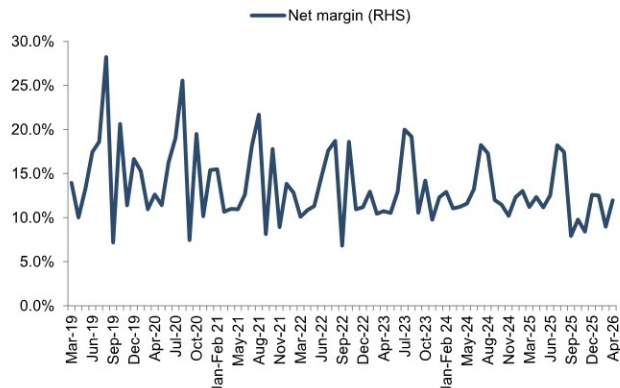
Security software companies registered in China: aggregate revenues and YoY growth



Source: MIIT

Exhibit 6: Net margin at 12.0% in Apr (vs. 9.0% in Mar 2026), leading to 4M26 NM at 11.4%

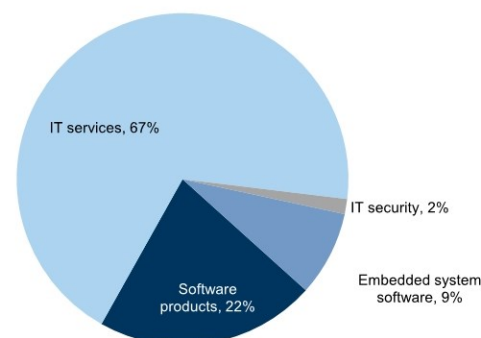
Software companies registered in China: aggregate NI YoY growth and net margin



Source: MIIT

Exhibit 7: IT services remain the key contributor

Software companies registered in China: aggregate revenues by subsector in 4M26

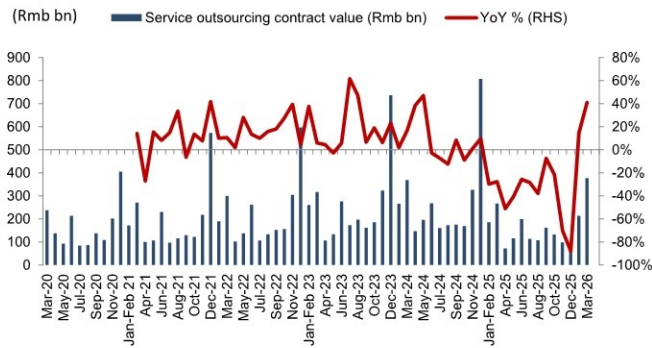


Source: MIIT

China security software / IT services market +5%/ +9% YoY in April 2026

- **China security software market revenue growth slowed in April:** In Apr, the aggregate revenue of security software companies registered in China was up 5% YoY Rmb20.8bn (US\$2.9bn), and 4M26 revenue to Rmb87bn (US\$12.1bn).
- **China IT services market revenue +9% YoY in April:** In April, the aggregate revenue of IT services companies registered in China was up 9% YoY to Rmb790bn (US\$110bn), and 4M26 revenue to Rmb3.1tn (US\$438bn), per MIIT.
- **Service outsourcing contract value increased in Mar 2026:** In March, the aggregate contract value of service outsourcing was up to Rmb377bn, and 1Q26 contract value to Rmb590bn, per Ministry of Commerce. The aggregate value of service outsourcing (execution) was up 91% YoY to Rmb284bn in Mar 2026, driven by rising AI-related projects.

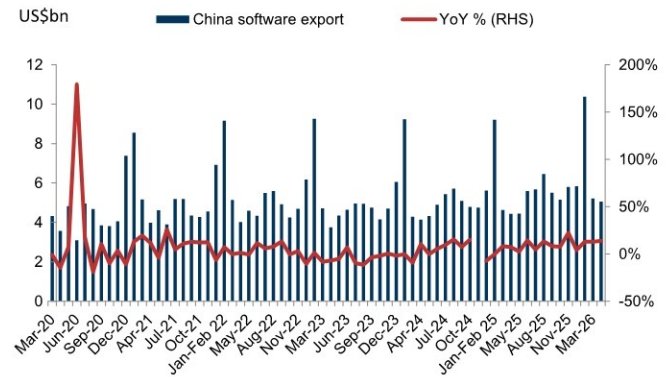
Exhibit 8: China service outsourcing contract value was up in Mar 2026



Source: Ministry of Commerce

Exhibit 9: Revenue from non-China markets went up in Apr (YoY)

Software companies registered in China: aggregate revenues from non-China markets



Source: MIIT

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Reg AC

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